Curvature and Torsion in the Continuum Theory of Lattice Defects

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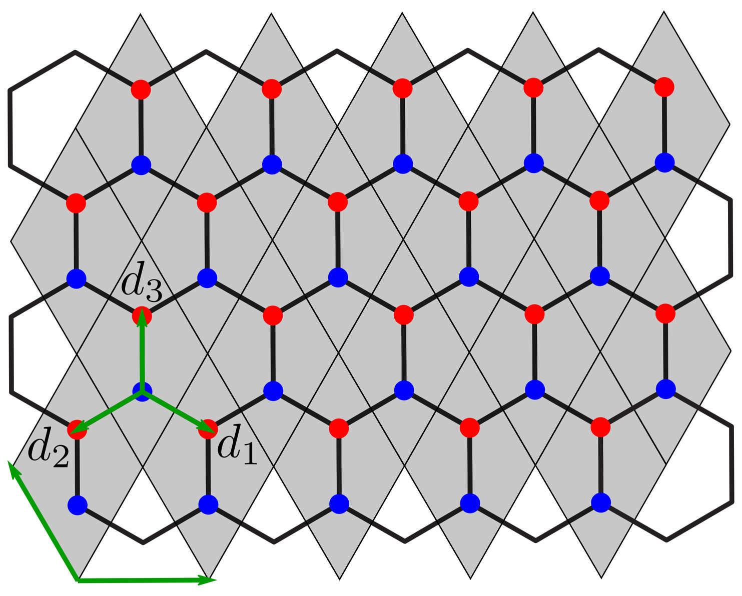
Offen im Denken

Continuum Theory - Graphene



Tight-binding Hamiltonian

$$H = \sum_{\vec{r}} \sum_{j=1}^{3} \left(a^\dagger_{\vec{r}} b_{\vec{r}+\vec{d}_j} + b^\dagger_{\vec{r}+\vec{d}_j} a_{\vec{r}} \right)$$

Fourier transform

$$i\partial_t \vec{\psi}(\vec{k}) = \boldsymbol{h}(\vec{k}) \vec{\psi}(\vec{k})$$

$$\boldsymbol{h}(\vec{k}) = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & f(\vec{k}) \\ f^*(\vec{k}) & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad f(\vec{k}) = \sum_{j=1}^{3} e^{i\vec{k}\cdot\vec{d}_j}$$

Linear dispersion around Dirac points

$$\vec{k} = \vec{K}^{(s)} + \delta\vec{k} \quad \Longrightarrow \quad \boldsymbol{h}(\vec{k}) \approx -\frac{3}{2} \delta\vec{k} \cdot \vec{\boldsymbol{\sigma}}$$

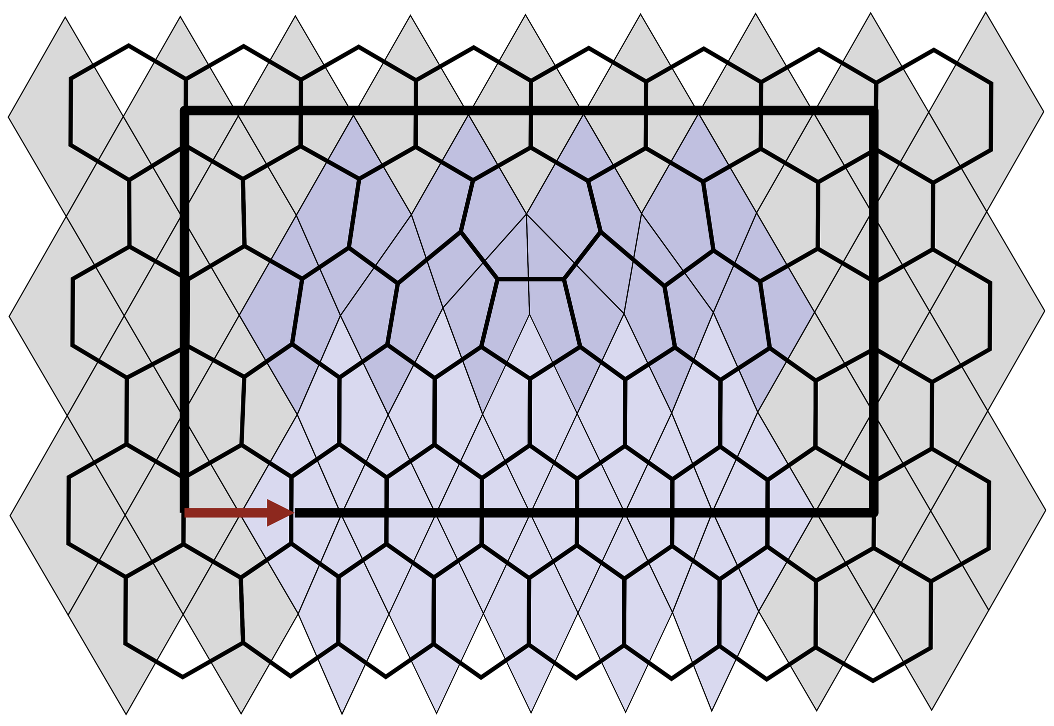
Continuum limit

$$i\partial_t \vec{\phi}(\vec{r}) = i\, c\, \boldsymbol{\sigma}^i \partial_i \vec{\phi}(\vec{r}), \qquad \rho = \vec{\phi}^\dagger \vec{\phi}, \qquad \vec{j} = -c \vec{\phi}^\dagger \vec{\boldsymbol{\sigma}} \vec{\phi}$$

$$\Updownarrow$$

$$i\gamma^\mu \partial_\mu \phi = 0, \quad \gamma^\mu = \sigma^\mu \sigma^3, \quad \mu \in \{0, 1, 2\}$$

Burgers vector in 5-7 defects



One 5-7 defect causes a lattice dislocation which can be described by the Burgers vector $\vec{b} = \sqrt{3}\,\vec{u}_x$

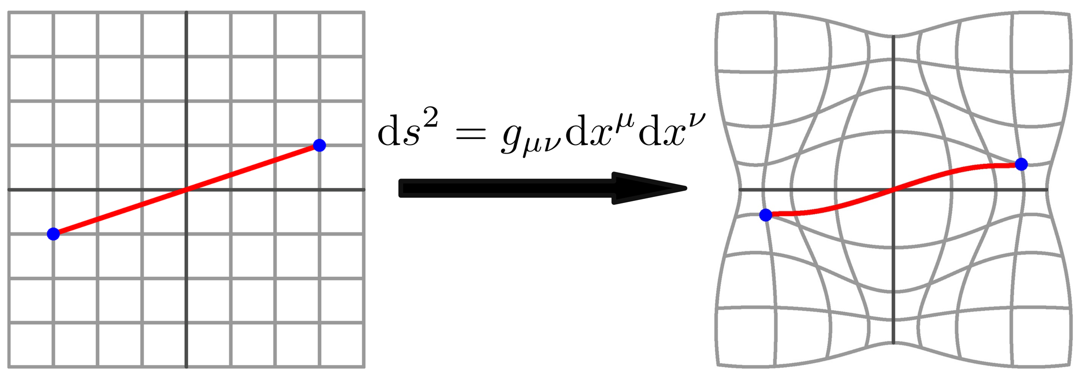
TODO:
In depth visual explanation of
torsion and how it is analogous
to the burgers vector

Riemannian Geometry

Riemannian Manifold $\mathcal{M}$ equipped with metric $g_{\mu\nu}$ and connection $\Gamma^\lambda{}_{\mu\nu}$.

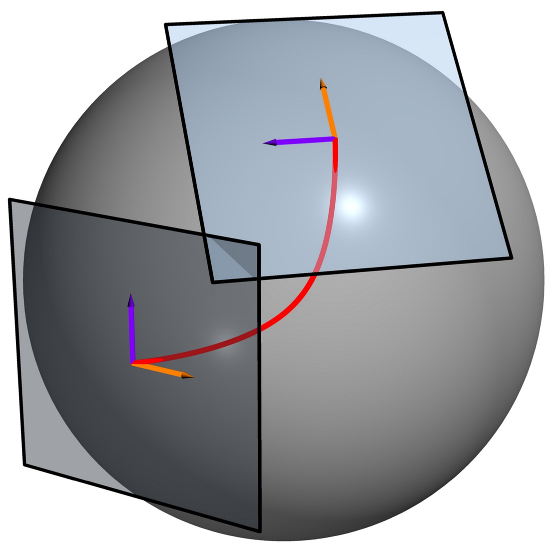
Metric

Defines distances and angles.



Connection

Connectes nearby **tangent spaces**, which allows the definition of a derivative on **vector fields** which take on values in the tangent space.



The unique torsion-free, metric compatible connection is called the Levi-Civita connection:

$$\left\{ {}^{\lambda}_{\mu\nu} \right\} = \frac{1}{2} g^{\lambda\rho} \left(\partial_\nu g_{\rho\mu} + \partial_\mu g_{\rho\nu} - \partial_\rho g_{\mu\nu} \right)$$

Covariant derivative

Takes into account the structure of the manifold and transforms like a tensor.

$$\nabla_\mu v^\nu = \partial_\mu v^\nu + \Gamma^\nu{}_{\mu\lambda} v^\lambda$$

Autoparallels

A curve whose tangent vector is parallel-transported along itself.

$$u^\mu \nabla_\mu u^\alpha = 0$$

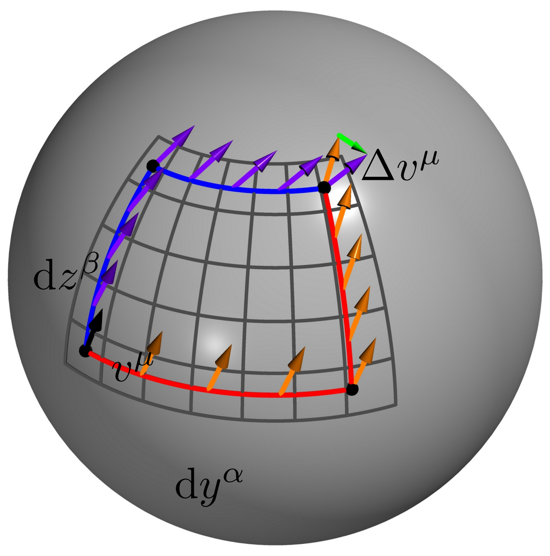
Curvature

The Riemann curvature tensor describes how parallel transport of vectors depends on the path.

$$\Delta v^\mu = R_{\alpha\beta}{}^\mu{}_\nu\, v^\nu\, \mathrm{d}y^\alpha\, \mathrm{d}z^\beta$$

It can be expressed in terms of the connection:

$$R_{\alpha\beta}{}^\mu{}_\nu = \partial_\alpha \Gamma^\mu{}_{\beta\nu} - \partial_\beta \Gamma^\mu{}_{\alpha\nu} + \Gamma^\mu{}_{\alpha\lambda}\Gamma^\lambda{}_{\beta\nu} - \Gamma^\mu{}_{\beta\lambda}\Gamma^\lambda{}_{\alpha\nu}$$



TODO:
Torsion <-> metric mapping
- Riemann curvature
- Autoparallels
->Problem with parallel transport
and tangent space in general

TODO:
Numerical implementation of
the tight binding hamiltonian
- details on defect modeling
- unitary timeevolution

TODO:
Numerical results
(tight binding vs. autoparallels)
Plot Scattering angle over defects

TODO:
Outlook
- Dirac equation on curved
backgroun with torsion
- Numeric simulations of this
for some torsion fields

TODO:
References